



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Guinea-Bissau. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that about yourself! Since you're 16, fluent in Danish, and just finished primary school (which in Denmark typically ends at 9th or 10th grade), you're at an important crossroad where you get to choose a path based on your interests, strengths, and goals.

In Denmark, after primary school (folkeskole), you generally have **three main educational options** to consider:

1. General Upper Secondary Education (Gymnasiale Uddannelser)

This path prepares you for higher education (like university).

Options:

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – broad general education, ideal if you're interested in academic subjects like history, science, literature, languages.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – focused on business, economics, and international trade.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – focuses on science and technology (great if you like math, tech, or natural sciences).
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – a 2-year program, often more practical and flexible, suitable if you want a shorter route to higher education.

Recommended if:

You like academic subjects, want to go to university later, or want to keep your options open.

2. Vocational Education and Training (Erhvervsuddannelser / EUD)

This is a hands-on education that combines school and paid internships (praktik), and leads directly to a job.

You can train to become:

- A carpenter, electrician, or mechanic
- A social and health care assistant
- A hairdresser, chef, or IT support technician
- Many more trades and service jobs

You'll also earn money during your apprenticeship.

Recommended if:

You prefer practical work, want to start working earlier, or want to become skilled in a specific trade.

3. Combination Programs (EUX)

This combines vocational training **with** upper secondary academic subjects. It takes a bit longer, but gives you both a professional qualification **and** the ability to apply to university.

Recommended if:

You want a skilled trade but also want the option to study further later.

How to Choose?

Ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy school subjects and want to go to university someday? → **STX, HHX, HTX, or HF**
 - Do I want to work with my hands, help people, or have a specific job in mind? → **EUD**
 - Do I want both a job and the option to study later? → **EUX**
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Additional Advice:

- **Talk to a school counselor (UU-vejleder)** – they can help based on your interests and grades.
 - **Visit schools** – most offer open house events (“åbent hus”) where you can see what the programs are like.
 - **Think about your interests** – do you enjoy helping people, solving problems, being creative, or building things?
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Would you like help figuring out what kind of subjects or jobs match your personality and interests? I can help with that too.